


# GET SWIFTY

## THE ALL-NEW MARUTI SUZUKI SWIFT HAS ARRIVED SPORTING A NEW LOOK, ADDED FEATURES AND A BRAND NEW PETROL ENGINE

BY DIPAYAN DUTTA

This new fourth generation model is still distinctly identifiable as a Swift. The front end is the most distinctive part with the sinewy flares of the fenders, a clamshell-like design for the bonnet and the headlamps that house LED projectors and boomerang DRLs. It gets 15-inch alloy wheels on the top-spec variant that look pretty cool, as do the smoked LED taillamps.

Inside, Maruti Suzuki has used contrasting textures like the silver inserts on the dashboard and the door panels that add to the premium perception. There's a 9-inch SmartPlay infotainment, the Arkamys audio system, and even wireless charging. The infotainment comes with wireless Apple CarPlay and Android Auto connectivity. The steering wheel is a flat-bottom unit adding to the sporty appeal of the cabin. The pod concept for the instruments goes against the grain of modern all-digital units. It does get a digital display at the centre, which integrates well with the dials without taking away from the retro theme. The second row gets its own AC vents, but that said the space is a little cramped, especially for taller individuals. The front seats, though, might just be the best in the segment. There's no rear-centre armrest although the back seat gets a 60:40 split option.

This Swift ditches the older K-series 4-cylinder for a 1.2-litre Z-series three-pot. It makes more torque in the lower reaches of the rev band, making it feel a whole lot quicker where it matters. It's only while pushing triple-digits that you feel the power start to taper off. There is a 5-speed manual on offer alongside a 5-speed AMT. The AMT happens to be more efficient at a claimed 25.8 kmpl compared to 24.8 kmpl of the manual. It makes a strong case for itself if a large part of your driving is in the urban jungle, but if you want to explore the extent of the Swift's performance, manual is the way to go. The suspension seems set up on the firmer side, but there is an admirable amount of damping for bumps and ruts and it rarely bottoms out. The firm springs paired with the taut chassis make for really good handling around corners.

**Maruti Suzuki Swift**
**Engine:** 1.2-litre petrol
**Power:** 82bhp@5,700rpm
**Torque:** 112Nm@4,300rpm
**Gearbox:** 5-speed MT/AMT
**Price:** ₹9.00/9.50 lakh (ex-showroom)

At Rs 9 lakh (ex-showroom) for the ZXi+ MT and another Rs 50,000 for the AMT, this new Swift isn't the most inexpensive hatch you can buy. But for the price, you get a car that pretty much does it all. It gets all the nice modern amenities and comfort you could want. It's a great handler and is pretty comfortable when the road surface isn't perfect. It looks striking and modern, and even though it is down on power, it is very engaging to drive. ■